DESIGN CASE STUDY

Simplifying an internal pricing tool

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ROLE	ORGANISATION	WHEN	TOOLS
User Design Intern (remote)	Rowanvale Books, an independent publisher	February to July 2024	Figma, Loom, email

A note on confidentiality. The original designs belong to Rowanvale Books and I am not able to share them. The diagrams in this document are my own illustrations of the type of change and of my process. They are labelled as illustrative and do not reproduce the real screens.

The problem

Rowanvale Books is an independent book publisher. Its staff use an internal pricing system to put together quotes for customers. The forms in that system contained around 50 fields. Not all of them were relevant to a given quote, but they were all there, which made the forms messy, hard to scan and heavy on information.

My role

I redesigned the forms in Figma as part of a remote UX internship. The main user of the system, who is also the company owner, was my point of contact. There was no fixed brief to follow. We worked iteratively from the start: I designed, shared and revised the screens, and the developers then built from them.

What I did

STEP 1

Separated what matters

I worked out which fields were relevant to producing a quote and made only those editable, so staff are not asked to deal with the rest.

STEP 2

Grouped and sectioned

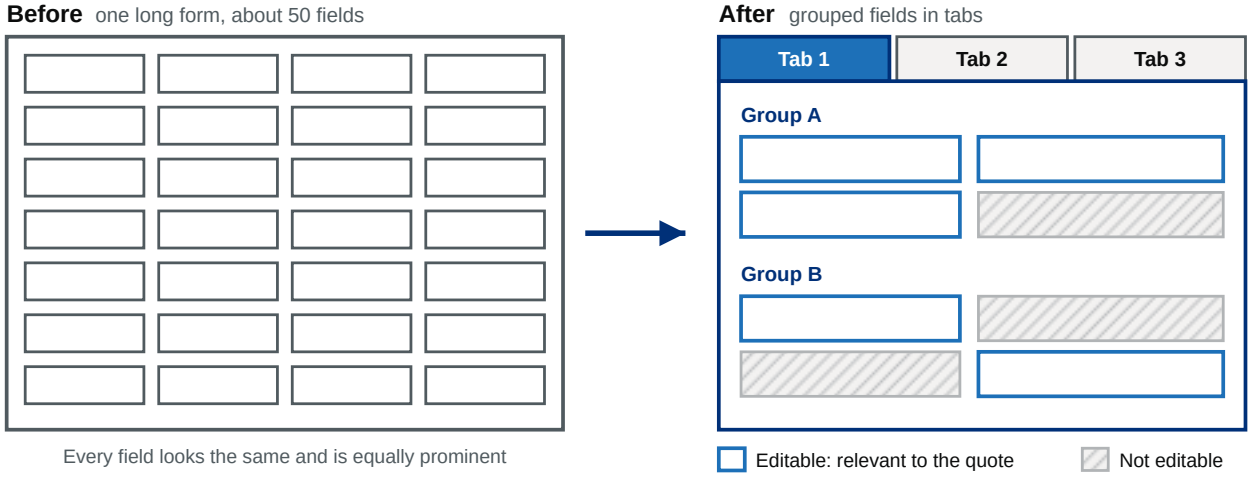
Related fields now sit together, and tabs break the form into smaller sections so nobody faces all 50 fields at once.

STEP 3

Checked against principles

I used UX principles from my degree to test each decision, mainly to reduce cognitive load (see the table on page 2).

ILLUSTRATIVE **The type of change: from one crowded form to grouped fields in tabs**

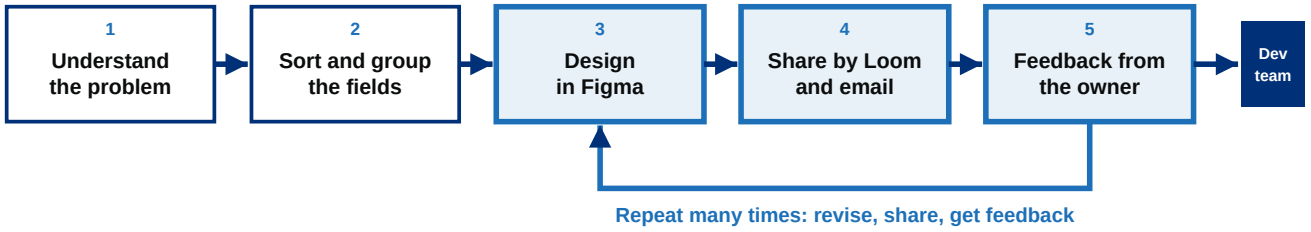


Illustrative schematic made for this case study. Field names, number of tabs and layout are generic and are not the original design.

How I worked: iterating with the owner, then handing over

I shared each version with the company owner, as the main user, through Loom walkthroughs and by email. That let me explain my reasoning and gave her something concrete to react to. We repeated the cycle many times, and the designs changed as her feedback came in. When they were ready, the developers used them to build the new forms. The designs gave them a clear view of what the owner wanted.

ILLUSTRATIVE **My working process**



Illustrative diagram of the process, drawn for this case study. The loop in steps 3 to 5 is where most of the work happened.

Principles, and the decisions they led to

Principle	What it meant for the forms
Reduce cognitive load	Only the fields that matter to a quote are editable, so people are not asked to process all 50.
Hick's Law	Fewer choices are shown at any one time, which makes the next action quicker to find.
Grouping (proximity)	Related fields sit next to each other under a clear heading.
Progressive disclosure	Tabs let people deal with one section at a time instead of the whole form.
Consistency and usability heuristics	I aimed for a predictable layout across the forms, and checked designs against Nielsen's usability heuristics.

Outcome

The redesign was taken forward into implementation, and the developers built from my designs.

I do not have usage data from after the build, so I am not claiming figures for time saved or fewer mistakes. What I can say is that the main user was involved throughout and that the designs were clear enough to build from.

What I would do next

- Test the new forms with several staff, timing how long a quote takes and noting where people hesitate.
- Check accessibility: keyboard use, colour contrast and plain-language labels.
- Compare the results with the old forms, so the changes are backed by evidence and not only by feedback.

How this connects to the GOV.UK design principles.

Start with user needs: I worked directly with the system's main user. **Do less:** only the relevant fields are editable. **Iterate, then iterate again:** the design changed through repeated rounds of feedback. It was a small project, but it showed me how these principles work in practice.